



IDJOY / PRACTICAL COMPANY RESOURCE

SEO + AI Search Readiness Checklist

Make your company easier to **understand, trust and find** - in Google, Bing, AI-assisted search and the buying journey that happens after discovery.

A practical, evidence-led checklist for business owners and marketing teams. No ranking guarantees. No mystery scores. No AI-search hacks that distract from the fundamentals.

Use it before: a website redesign, an SEO retainer, a content campaign, an AI-search visibility project, or any major website investment.

COMPANY DETAILS

IDJOY (Pty) Ltd
Pretoria, South Africa
Registration: 2024/464477/07
Website: idjoy.co.za
Evidence-led websites, SEO and search visibility.

How to use this checklist

Score the company honestly, fix blockers first, then build the content and evidence system that compounds over time.

THE THREE TESTS

Understand: Can a buyer and a search system tell what you do, who it is for and where you operate?

Trust: Can they inspect proof, credentials, people, policies, reviews, case studies and specific claims?

Find: Can crawlers reach the right pages, interpret them and connect them to the searches and questions buyers use?

Score each section from 0 to 10

- | | |
|---|----------------------------|
| ☐ 0-3: Unclear or unverified
Important pieces are missing, blocked or assumptions. | Owner: _____
Due: _____ |
| ☐ 4-6: Working but inconsistent
Foundations exist, but gaps make discovery or buying harder. | Owner: _____
Due: _____ |
| ☐ 7-8: Strong
Important journeys are clear, evidence-led and measurable. | Owner: _____
Due: _____ |
| ☐ 9-10: Mature
The system is maintained, measured and improved without hacks. | Owner: _____
Due: _____ |

PRIORITY RULE

P0 - blocks crawling, indexing, trust or enquiries. Fix now.

P1 - material visibility or conversion issue. Fix next.

P2 - meaningful improvement. Schedule.

P3 - polish or experiment after the system works.

Business clarity and measurement

SEO becomes expensive when the company has not defined the buyer, commercial offer and result worth measuring.

☐	Write the primary commercial outcome for the website in one sentence. Qualified enquiries, bookings, quote requests or sales.	Owner: _____ Due: _____
☐	Name the 1-3 buyer groups the website must help. Use real roles, industries, problems or locations - not everyone.	Owner: _____ Due: _____
☐	List the services/products that directly generate revenue. Separate core offers from support information and experiments.	Owner: _____ Due: _____
☐	Define what a qualified enquiry looks like. Include fit, budget, location, urgency or service type where relevant.	Owner: _____ Due: _____
☐	Confirm analytics is collecting useful events. Track forms, calls, WhatsApp, bookings, checkout or other commercial actions.	Owner: _____ Due: _____
☐	Connect Google Search Console and Bing Webmaster Tools. Use first-party evidence for indexation, queries and performance.	Owner: _____ Due: _____
☐	Record a baseline before major changes. Capture qualified enquiries, impressions, clicks and key organic landing pages.	Owner: _____ Due: _____
☐	Assign one person who owns search measurement. A report with no decision owner is only documentation.	Owner: _____ Due: _____

CLARITY

____ / 10

MEASUREMENT

____ / 10

OWNERSHIP

____ / 10

Crawling, indexing and technical access

A brilliant page cannot perform if search systems cannot reliably reach, render or index the version you intend.

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|--------------------------|--|----------------------------|
| ☐ | Verify important public pages return a successful HTTP response.
Fix broken, looping, protected or server-error pages. | Owner: _____
Due: _____ |
| ☐ | Review robots.txt for accidental blocks.
Money pages should not be blocked by mistake. | Owner: _____
Due: _____ |
| ☐ | Confirm XML sitemaps include canonical, indexable pages only.
Remove redirecting, duplicate, noindex and private URLs. | Owner: _____
Due: _____ |
| ☐ | Check canonical tags on important templates.
Do not point distinct pages to the wrong canonical. | Owner: _____
Due: _____ |
| ☐ | Check noindex directives on key pages.
A staging rule copied to production can erase visibility. | Owner: _____
Due: _____ |
| ☐ | Confirm HTTPS, one preferred hostname and clean redirects.
Resolve URL variants consistently. | Owner: _____
Due: _____ |
| ☐ | Test JavaScript-rendered content.
Important text and links should not depend on fragile interactions. | Owner: _____
Due: _____ |
| ☐ | Inspect status codes after redesigns or migrations.
Use 301 redirects for replaced URLs. | Owner: _____
Due: _____ |
| ☐ | Keep private customer/account routes out of search.
robots.txt is not access control. | Owner: _____
Due: _____ |

ACCESS

____ / 10

INDEXING

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MIGRATION SAFETY

____ / 10

Website structure and search intent

The site should mirror the way a buyer understands the problem - not an internal org chart.

- | | | |
|--------------------------|--|----------------------------|
| ☐ | Give every important service a useful canonical destination.
Avoid one vague Services page if buyers search for distinct offers. | Owner: _____
Due: _____ |
| ☐ | Map one primary intent to each important page.
Prevent thin pages from competing for the same job. | Owner: _____
Due: _____ |
| ☐ | Use descriptive navigation labels.
Use labels buyers understand without decoding. | Owner: _____
Due: _____ |
| ☐ | Keep high-value pages within sensible click depth.
Important pages should be reachable through normal navigation. | Owner: _____
Due: _____ |
| ☐ | Create useful topic hubs only where a topic has depth.
Hubs should explain and connect, not hold keywords. | Owner: _____
Due: _____ |
| ☐ | Avoid doorway pages for every city or keyword variant.
Location pages need real local usefulness and evidence. | Owner: _____
Due: _____ |
| ☐ | Use breadcrumbs where hierarchy is meaningful.
Help users and systems understand location in the site. | Owner: _____
Due: _____ |
| ☐ | Maintain a URL inventory during major changes.
Know what is kept, merged, redirected or retired. | Owner: _____
Due: _____ |

ARCHITECTURE

____ / 10

INTENT

____ / 10

NAVIGATION

____ / 10

On-page clarity and useful content

Answer the buyer's question quickly, then earn the next minute of attention with useful depth.

☐	Make the page title specific, useful and unique. Lead with topic and value; avoid keyword stuffing.	Owner: _____ Due: _____
☐	Use one clear H1 that describes the page. Match the user's expected destination.	Owner: _____ Due: _____
☐	Answer the primary question near the top. Do not hide the offer behind brand poetry.	Owner: _____ Due: _____
☐	Explain who the service is for and when it is relevant. Specificity improves qualification.	Owner: _____ Due: _____
☐	Explain outcomes before drowning the visitor in features. Translate expertise into the buyer's desired result.	Owner: _____ Due: _____
☐	Break complex work into understandable stages. A visible process reduces uncertainty.	Owner: _____ Due: _____
☐	Write descriptive link text. Give context instead of generic click here links.	Owner: _____ Due: _____
☐	Use original images, diagrams, examples or data. Commodity text alone is rarely defensible.	Owner: _____ Due: _____
☐	Add a next step matched to readiness. Inspect, calculate, download, book, enquire or request quote.	Owner: _____ Due: _____

RELEVANCE

____ / 10

USEFULNESS

____ / 10

CONVERSION

____ / 10

Trust, evidence and structured data

A strong public story is specific, consistent and supported by evidence a buyer can inspect.

- | | | |
|--------------------------|--|----------------------------|
| ☐ | Show the real business name and contact route clearly.
Keep it consistent across important profiles. | Owner: _____
Due: _____ |
| ☐ | Show who is behind the business.
Use real people and relevant credentials. | Owner: _____
Due: _____ |
| ☐ | Publish case studies with specific problems, work and proof.
Do not invent conversion figures. | Owner: _____
Due: _____ |
| ☐ | Use testimonials/reviews only when authentic.
Never manufacture reviews. | Owner: _____
Due: _____ |
| ☐ | Show certifications, memberships or compliance proof.
Explain what the credential proves. | Owner: _____
Due: _____ |
| ☐ | Make policies easy to find.
Privacy, terms and service conditions reduce uncertainty. | Owner: _____
Due: _____ |
| ☐ | Implement structured data only for facts present on the page.
Schema describes; it does not invent. | Owner: _____
Due: _____ |
| ☐ | Validate structured data after deployment.
Check syntax and rendered output. | Owner: _____
Due: _____ |
| ☐ | Keep organisation details consistent.
Name, URL, phone, address and profiles should not contradict. | Owner: _____
Due: _____ |

EVIDENCE

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ENTITY CLARITY

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SCHEMA

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Local SEO for companies serving real locations

Local visibility comes from accurate business information, relevant location evidence and a site that explains where the company can help.

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|--------------------------|--|----------------------------|
| ☐ | Claim and maintain Google Business Profile where eligible.
Use real name, primary category, hours and contact information. | Owner: _____
Due: _____ |
| <hr/> | | |
| ☐ | Keep name, address/service area and phone details consistent.
Fix meaningful contradictions. | Owner: _____
Due: _____ |
| <hr/> | | |
| ☐ | Choose categories based on actual services.
Do not add unrelated categories for search volume. | Owner: _____
Due: _____ |
| <hr/> | | |
| ☐ | Complete services, products, photos and business description.
Use current information and real media. | Owner: _____
Due: _____ |
| <hr/> | | |
| ☐ | Build an ethical review process.
Never buy, gate or fabricate reviews. | Owner: _____
Due: _____ |
| <hr/> | | |
| ☐ | Create location pages only with genuine relevance.
Add local proof, projects, logistics or constraints. | Owner: _____
Due: _____ |
| <hr/> | | |
| ☐ | Embed local evidence in case studies.
Show area, sector, challenge and delivery context where useful. | Owner: _____
Due: _____ |
| <hr/> | | |
| ☐ | Track local enquiries, not rankings alone.
Calls, directions, messages and qualified leads matter more. | Owner: _____
Due: _____ |

PROFILE

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CONSISTENCY

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LOCAL EVIDENCE

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Page experience, mobile and performance

Performance is part of the buying experience. Optimise the pages people actually use instead of chasing a lab score.

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|--------------------------|--|----------------------------|
| ☐ | Test the site on a real mobile viewport.
Check navigation, forms, sticky elements, tap targets and overflow. | Owner: _____
Due: _____ |
| ☐ | Monitor Core Web Vitals on important templates.
Prioritise recurring real-user issues. | Owner: _____
Due: _____ |
| ☐ | Compress and size images appropriately.
Avoid oversized hero assets. | Owner: _____
Due: _____ |
| ☐ | Reduce render-blocking or unnecessary scripts.
Third-party tags can quietly erode experience. | Owner: _____
Due: _____ |
| ☐ | Prevent major layout shifts.
Reserve space for media, fonts and dynamic elements. | Owner: _____
Due: _____ |
| ☐ | Make forms short, clear and resilient.
Label fields and show errors well. | Owner: _____
Due: _____ |
| ☐ | Check keyboard and basic accessibility.
Semantics, contrast, focus and labels improve robustness. | Owner: _____
Due: _____ |
| ☐ | Measure performance after deployment.
A redesign can regress in production. | Owner: _____
Due: _____ |

MOBILE

____ / 10

PERFORMANCE

____ / 10

ACCESSIBILITY

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AI-search readiness

Treat AI-assisted discovery as an extension of good SEO: make public facts clear, crawlable, consistent and worth citing.

- | | | |
|--------------------------|--|----------------------------|
| ☐ | Keep important business facts on public, crawlable pages.
Do not leave services, locations, people or proof only in images/private PDFs. | Owner: _____
Due: _____ |
| ☐ | Do not block search crawlers you intentionally want.
Review robots rules, CDN/WAF rules and bot mitigation together. | Owner: _____
Due: _____ |
| ☐ | For ChatGPT search, review access for OAI-SearchBot.
GPTBot is a separate training-related control. | Owner: _____
Due: _____ |
| ☐ | Do not create AI-only claims, fake citations or hidden machine text.
Public evidence should help humans too. | Owner: _____
Due: _____ |
| ☐ | Use schema to describe real entities and content.
There is no special guaranteed AI-ranking schema. | Owner: _____
Due: _____ |
| ☐ | Keep concise factual summaries near their evidence.
Reduce ambiguity without answer spam. | Owner: _____
Due: _____ |
| ☐ | Build quotable original evidence.
Case studies, data, methods and calculators can add value. | Owner: _____
Due: _____ |
| ☐ | Treat llms.txt as optional experimentation.
Do not present it as a ranking requirement. | Owner: _____
Due: _____ |
| ☐ | Measure AI visibility with repeated tests and referral/conversion data.
One chatbot screenshot is not market share. | Owner: _____
Due: _____ |

CRAWLER ACCESS

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EVIDENCE

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MEASUREMENT

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Content portfolio and internal linking

Publish less generic content and more pages that answer a commercial question, show evidence, or support a decision.

- | | | |
|--------------------------|---|----------------------------|
| ☐ | Inventory existing content before creating more.
Keep, refresh, consolidate, redirect or retire. | Owner: _____
Due: _____ |
| ☐ | Prioritise topics close to buyer decisions.
Cost, fit, comparison, process, risk, alternatives and requirements. | Owner: _____
Due: _____ |
| ☐ | Create topic clusters only where expertise and demand justify them.
Avoid thin variants for coverage theatre. | Owner: _____
Due: _____ |
| ☐ | Link informational content to the relevant commercial destination.
Make the next step useful. | Owner: _____
Due: _____ |
| ☐ | Link commercial pages back to evidence.
Case studies, FAQs and credentials help validation. | Owner: _____
Due: _____ |
| ☐ | Refresh stale facts, screenshots and service details.
An indexed page can still lose trust when outdated. | Owner: _____
Due: _____ |
| ☐ | Merge pages duplicating the same intent.
Consolidation can improve clarity and maintenance. | Owner: _____
Due: _____ |
| ☐ | Keep editorial standards for AI-assisted writing.
Human review must verify claims, originality, examples and voice. | Owner: _____
Due: _____ |

PORTFOLIO

____ / 10

INTERNAL LINKS

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EDITORIAL QUALITY

____ / 10

Measurement, maintenance and the next 90 days

Search is a system, not a one-time launch task. Build a rhythm that connects visibility changes to business outcomes.

- | | | |
|--------------------------|---|----------------------------|
| ☐ | Review Search Console and Bing data monthly.
Watch indexation, query groups, landing pages and unusual changes. | Owner: _____
Due: _____ |
| ☐ | Review qualified organic enquiries monthly.
Separate traffic growth from commercial progress. | Owner: _____
Due: _____ |
| ☐ | Track major website changes on a changelog.
Know what changed and when. | Owner: _____
Due: _____ |
| ☐ | Re-check crawl/index rules after deployments.
Robots, canonicals, sitemaps and redirects deserve regression tests. | Owner: _____
Due: _____ |
| ☐ | Review content performance by intent, not word count.
Ask whether each page helps discovery, trust, evaluation or conversion. | Owner: _____
Due: _____ |
| ☐ | Re-test AI-search visibility using a stable prompt set.
Record engine, date, result, cited sources and material accuracy. | Owner: _____
Due: _____ |
| ☐ | Review external business profiles quarterly.
Update hours, services, staff, locations and key facts. | Owner: _____
Due: _____ |
| ☐ | Build the next quarter around the biggest evidence-backed constraint.
Do not let a content calendar substitute for strategy. | Owner: _____
Due: _____ |

BUSINESS IMPACT

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SEARCH EVIDENCE

____ / 10

MAINTENANCE

____ / 10

Turn the audit into a 30 / 60 / 90 day plan

A checklist only creates value when it changes priorities. Convert findings into a short operating plan.

30 DAYS - REMOVE BLOCKERS	60 DAYS - BUILD EVIDENCE	90 DAYS - COMPOUND
P0/P1 crawl and index fixes Measurement baseline Primary page clarity Business info consistency Critical mobile/form issues Owner: _____	Service-page clarity Case studies and proof Internal-link routes Local profile improvements Schema on verified entities Owner: _____	High-intent content Refresh/merge weak pages Performance improvements AI-search monitoring set Quarterly roadmap Owner: _____

Leadership scorecard

Section	Score /10	Top constraint	Next decision
01 Business clarity and measure	_____	_____	_____
02 Crawling, indexing and techn	_____	_____	_____
03 Website structure and search	_____	_____	_____
04 On-page clarity and useful c	_____	_____	_____
05 Trust, evidence and structur	_____	_____	_____
06 Local SEO for companies serv	_____	_____	_____
07 Page experience, mobile and	_____	_____	_____
08 AI-search readiness	_____	_____	_____
09 Content portfolio and intern	_____	_____	_____
10 Measurement, maintenance and	_____	_____	_____

What "good" looks like

You need a website that communicates the right facts, earns confidence, is technically accessible and gives measurement enough time to show what is changing.

UNDERSTAND

A qualified buyer can explain what you do, who it is for, why it matters and what happens next after scanning the page for less than a minute.

TRUST

Important claims have inspectable proof: real people, credentials, projects, policies, reviews, examples, processes or data.

FIND

Important pages can be crawled, indexed and connected to the language buyers use. Search and AI systems encounter clear, consistent public information.

Before you pay for more traffic

Fix clarity and evidence gaps that make qualified visitors hesitate. More traffic sent into an unclear buying journey usually scales the confusion too.

FREE NEXT STEP

Use the IDJOY AI Visibility Scanner to inspect public crawler access, machine understanding, business clarity, trust evidence and search footprint. Visit idjoy.co.za.

Reference standard

Built around durable guidance from Google Search Central, Bing Webmaster guidance, OpenAI crawler documentation and the open Agent Skills ecosystem. Re-check current platform documentation before crawler-specific changes.

IDJOY (Pty) Ltd

Evidence-led websites, SEO and search visibility for businesses that need buyers to understand complex work, inspect the proof and know what to do next.

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Important: SEO rankings, search features and AI citations are not guaranteed. Use this as an operating checklist, not a promise of placement or revenue.